

Again we offer unto thee this rational worship for those who have fallen asleep in the faith: ancestors, fathers, patriarchs, prophets, apostles, preachers, evangelists, martyrs, confessors, ascetics, and every righteous spirit made perfect in faith: *The priest takes the censer and says:*

Exclamation: Especially for our most holy, most pure, most blessed and glorious Lady Theotokos and Ever-virgin Mary;

He censes before the holy table three times. Then the deacon censes around the holy table, remembering whom he wishes from among the departed and the living.

Meanwhile, the singers:¹

It is truly meet to bless thee, O Theotokos, ever-blessed and most pure and the Mother of our God. More honorable than the cherubim and more glorious beyond compare than the seraphim, without corruption thou gavest birth to God the Word: true Theotokos, we magnify thee.

The priest prays:

For the holy Prophet, Forerunner, and Baptist John; for the holy, glorious, and all-laudable apostles, for Saint *N.*, whose memory we keep this day, and for all thy saints, at whose supplications, visit us, O God.

¹ For feasts, see pp. 302ff. for the appropriate megalynarion.